

7 Things to consider before buying a house in Bhopal

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Executive Summary

Thinking about buying a house in Bhopal? It's a huge step, and this guide breaks down seven key things to keep in mind so you can make a smart choice.

First up, really think about the location. It's not just about being close to your job or the market now; you should also peek at the city's Master Plan to guess how the area might grow in the future. When you visit a potential colony, check out the layout. You want to see wide roads, ideally 25-30 feet, so you don't have to deal with traffic jams just to get home. Inside the house, look for smart designs with good airflow and natural light.

Before you get too attached, do your homework on the builder and the project's legal status. You can find most of the important documents, like RERA approval and land titles, on the MP RERA website. Don't just get wowed by the fancy clubhouse; make sure basics like water, power backup, and security are solid.

On the money side of things, remember you can get tax breaks on your principal and interest payments if you use the old tax regime. Getting a loan depends on your income and a CIBIL score over 700. Finally, ask about who handles maintenance after you move in, so there are no surprises down the road.

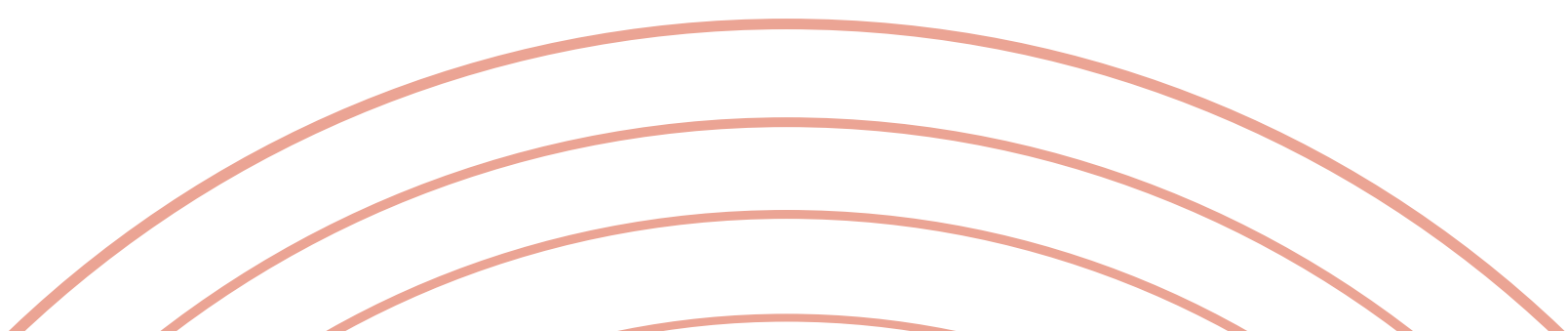


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One way to check this is by looking at the existing Master [HG1] Plan of the city and taking an educated guess about the future prospects of that area.

mptownplan.gov.in/plan_bhopal.html

संचालनालय नगर तथा ग्राम निवेश , मध्य प्रदेश शासन DIRECTORATE OF TOWN AND COUNTRY PLANNING GOVERNMENT OF MADHYA PRADESH

मुख्य पृष्ठ स्थापना योजनाएँ ई-सेवाएँ लोक सेवा सूचना का अधिकार नियम/अधिनियम सुझाव कार्यक्षेत्र एवं क्षेत्राधिकार विकास प्राधिकरण एवं साडा

▶ Development Permission

▶ Development Plan

▶ District Offices

▶ Bhopal

▶ Indore

▶ Gwalior

▶ Jabalpur

▶ Rewa

▶ Sagar

▶ Ujjain

▶ Guna

▶ Neemuch

▶ Shahdol

▶ Khandwa

▶ Satna

▶ Dewas

▶ Rajgarh

▶ Vidisha

▶ Hoshangabad

▶ Betul

▶ Bhind

▶ Jhabua

▶ Mandla

LAYOUTS OF CAPITAL PROJECT AREA

[Approved layout of the Industrial Sector of the Bhopal District](#)

[नियोजन तैथिकी](#)

Bhopal :
Bhopal Development Plan 2031 (Draft)

Hindi	भाग 1	भाग 2	भाग 3
English	Volume 1	Volume 2	Volume 3

Zone Map	Zone Map with Khasra	Road Network
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Panel Maps

SNO.	Panel No	Panel No	Panel No
1	Panel No 1	Panel No 2	Panel No 3
2	Panel No 4	Panel No 5	Panel No 6
3	Panel No 7	Panel No 8	Panel No 9
4	Panel No 10	Panel No 11	Panel No 12
5	Panel No 13	Panel No 14	

[Bhopal Development Plan 2005 English](#)

[Bhopal Development Plan 2005 \(Hindi\)](#)

[Bhopal Development Plan 1991 \(English\)](#)

[Bhopal Development Plan 1991 \(Hindi\)](#)

[Bhopal Development Plan 2005 \(DRAFT\) Hindi](#)

[Bhopal Development Plan 2005 \(DRAFT\) English](#)

Development Plan

नवीन सूचनाएँ

[Read More](#)

HG 1: Bhopal Master Plan



2.1 Colony Layout

When assessing the layout of a colony, you should be looking for open spaces, green areas, width of the colony roads and recreational areas. A well-planned township should feel spacious, and not overly dense. The ideal colony road size should be 25-30 ft because you have to account for car parking on both, the right- and the left-hand side of the road. Anything less and you will have trouble navigating the township.

2.2 Floor plan

2.2.1 For Duplexes/triplexes

Most people look at the sizes of the bedrooms and kitchen etc, however, home design should foster relations and communication in a family. You should look at the layout of the home with that lens. Inter-floor connectivity is one key thing to keep in mind. A home should always feel connected from all the areas, through the use of double heights, wide staircases and open layouts in the common areas[HG2].

2.2.2 For Flats

Good architecture considers ventilation and sunlight light access in every room. Dark rooms are depressing; you are buying a place you can all home. Natural light [HG3] is necessary for your families’ mental wellbeing

2.2.3 Space utilization

See how the developer has designed the house to understand how interior spaces are efficiently utilized. Are there any awkward corners, unusable spaces or long dark lobbies at the entrance of the house?

HG 2 – Vardhman Fairmont Ivy Villa





2.2.4 Privacy

Pay special attention to the placement of windows, doors and balconies to ensure privacy, especially if your home is a flat in a multi-story building. High density projects, busy localities, closeness to railway station/tracks while might increase the prices of the property but they can be quite noisy.

This is a tradeoff which can be mitigated by using high quality windows which provide insulation. Ask your developer about the details of the windows and doors.

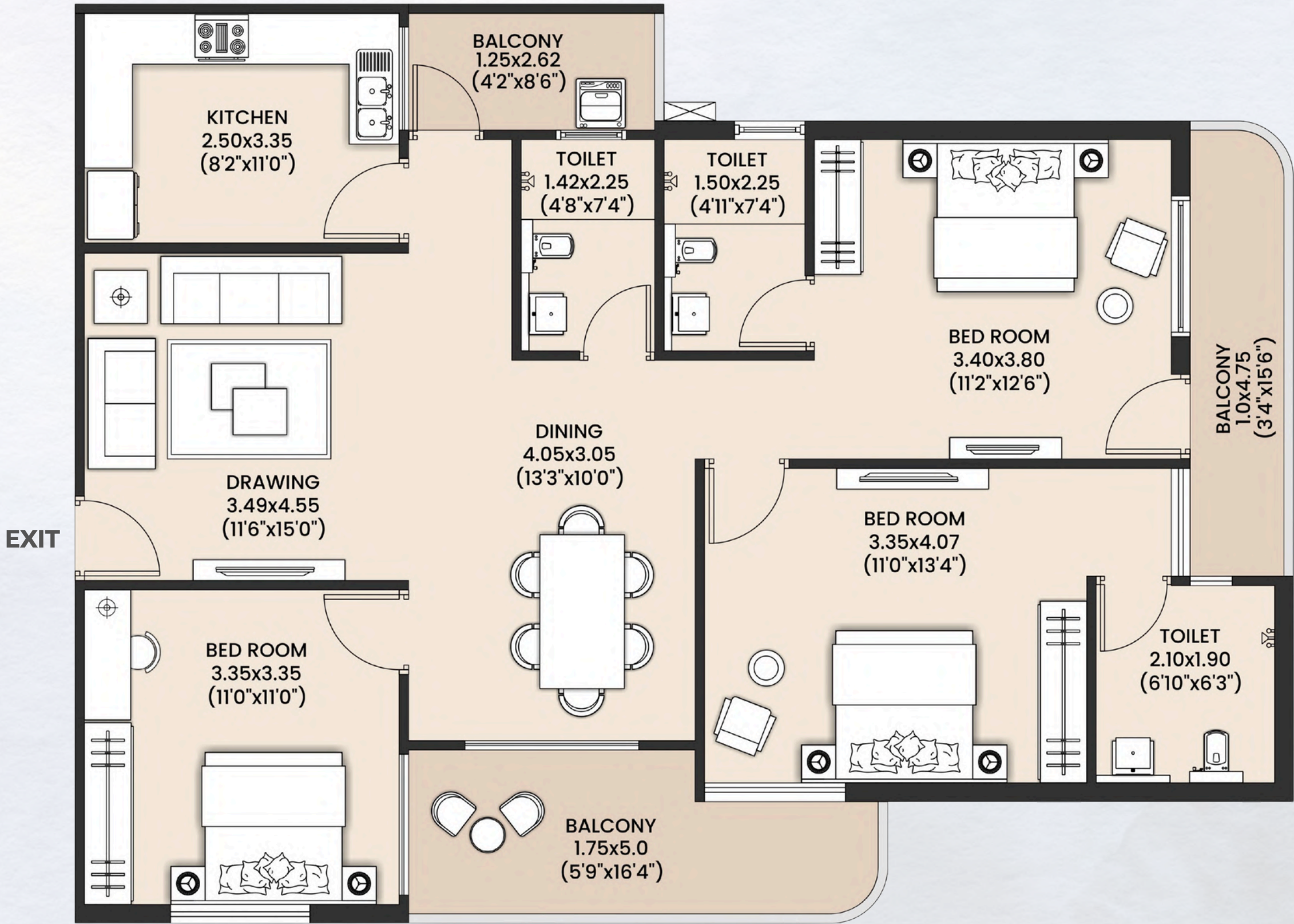
Another important issue is to consider if the township has efficient rainwater drainage. Visit the colony during the monsoon season to understand where the slope of the land and drainage of excess water.

2.2.5 Vastu

Open any brochure a developer gives you, all of them say their colony is Vastu complaint. Honestly, it's very rare that every single unit can be Vastu compliant. Developers have space and design constraints and have to face trade -offs. In one multi story building, you will have both, east and west facing flats. In residential colonies, you will have both sher mukhi ghar and gow mukhi ghar, because not all plots will be in the perfect shape. Keeping this in mind you should look if the design of the flats/house doesn't contradict the Vastu rules of architecture.

That being said, good developers put real effort in following the Vastu norms as much as its practically possible in their colony. If you are concerned about Vastu compliances, buy early while the project is under construction, so you have more choice to choose from, once the colony is developed, and early movers' advantage has faded away, then not only are you paying a high price for a home in the same project where other bought it for cheap, but you also have less options to choose from. Don't be the last one to the party.

HG 3 – Vardhman Celestia 3 BHK TYPE A





All the developers advertise lifestyle benefits on the brochures, but what you should be asking them about, is the robustness of basic amenities. Look for reliable water supply, power backup, well-functioning sewage system and waste management. That being said, clubhouses, swimming pools, gyms, parks, sport facilities and proximity to shops should not be overlooked.



3.3.1 Security:

We will be honest; we have had a very bad experience with security companies in the past. Their guards are over worked, working 2 to 3 shifts without a break. In our project Vardhman City, we poached our main guard from the security company and got him on our pay roll. HD CCTV cameras are obvious; we always use those at our sites. It’s our ongoing endeavor to ensure your safety.

3.3.2 Disaster management

Do not overlook disaster management. We have experienced it first hand when our dragon fruit farm caught fire. Luckily none of our staff members were injured. Since then, we have been extra conscious regarding fire safety, emergency exits, emergency water supply etc.





4.1 Home maintenance

Look how responsive the developer is towards home maintenance and repair requests after purchase. Also note, that while it is easy to form your opinion on the basis of one flawed review, understand that sometimes customer demands are unreasonable. We usually take house maintenance responsibility for the first 3 years after sales, but beyond that is customer's responsibility.

4.2 Colony Maintenance

Find out what colony maintenance services are included? We usually cover, colony cleaning, garden maintenance, security, common area lighting etc. But eventually maintenance is handed over to the society after the completion and sale of the project by the builder. Then it's up to the residents to maintain the colony. However, our township Vardhman City is an exception where we still do colony maintenance despite selling all the homes.

4.3 Township Planning and Development Timeline

Townships are developed in phases, beware how this can impact your property, traffic within the township and access to amenities. For example, sometimes traffic can get blocked because of the ongoing construction work of the next phase.





Do your research thoroughly. A background check on the developer, execution of past projects and project quality given the quality standards of construction at that time, would give you a rough idea about the developer's ability to execute and finish the project.

Ensure that the township has received all the necessary government approvals, and clear land titles. You can look for the following documents of the project on the MP RERA portal –

1. TNCP Layout (Town & country planning layout)
2. Nazul NOC & Diversion (If the project is being constructed on an agricultural land and has been passed as residential in the Master Plan)
3. Nagar Nigam Development Permission
4. Nagar Nigam Building permission (Only after this can a developer commence construction)
5. RERA (Most of the above documents can be found on the RERA portal, ask for the RERA no. from the developer)
6. Title of the Land
7. Title deed

RERA:

On the RERA portal,[HG2] you can have a look at all the documents and do your own due diligence on the promoter regarding the legal clearances.

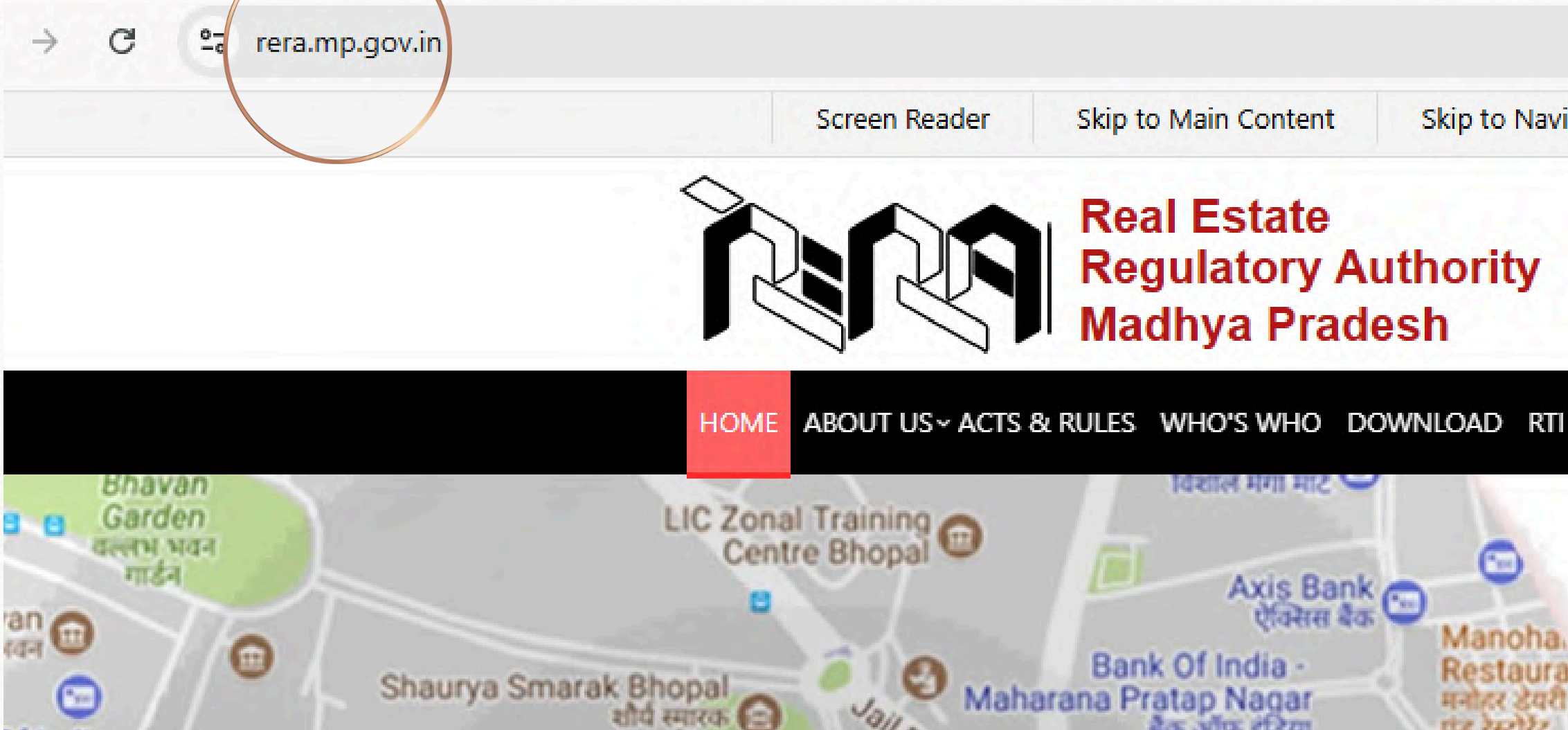
The builder has to submit CA certificate, Engineer's certificate and actual site photographs every quarter to depict the actual progress of the project. These will give you a rough idea to predict the possibility of timely possession.



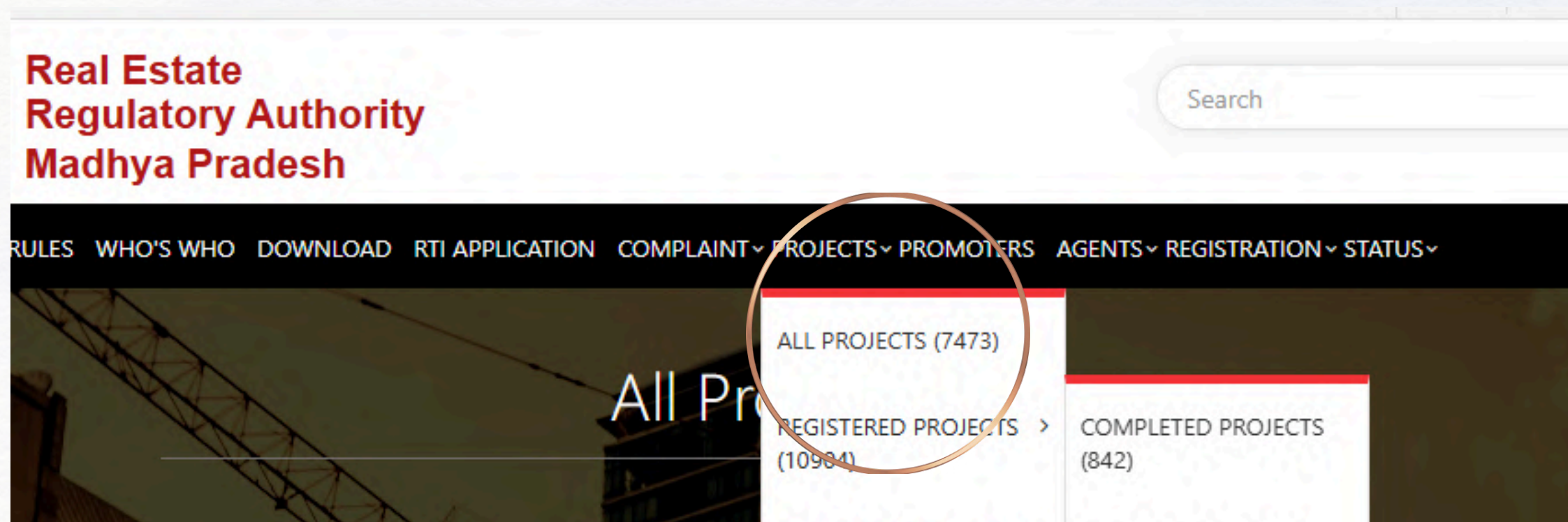


Steps to find information about a RERA approved project:

Visit: <https://www.rera.mp.gov.in/>



Select project from drop down list



Search for the project name through the search box

Search results for 'vardhman fairmont'.

Search box: vardhman fairmont | Select project type | Select District | Search

Show 10 | Total Records: 7473 | Filter:

S.No.	Project Name	Promoter Name	District – Planning Area	Status
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You will find all the information about any RERA approved project

Project Information	
Project Name :	VARDHMAN FAIRMONT
Registration Number :	P-BPL-23-4246
Project Type :	New
Application Status :	Approved



6.1 Tax exemptions at the time of Purchase

When you are purchasing a new house, you can avail certain tax exemptions. There are two tax regimes within which you can file your ITR. Within the new tax regime, you do NOT get any tax deduction. However, within the old tax regime, you can get deduction on

- Interest component, under section 24 B
- Principal repayment, under section 80 C
- Stamp duty and registration charges under 80C



Please note that there is a capping of 2 lakh rupees for interest under 24 B for self-occupied property. Also, under section 80 C you get deduction on a lot of things including principal repayment, but the total capping under 80 C is of 1.5 Lakhs.

20%

Capital Gain Tax

Deductions under different sections on



Interest Components



Principal Repayment



Stamp Duty & Registration charges



6.2 Capital Gains Tax at the time of Sale

A house is a capital asset. Any appreciation in the value of the property at the time of sale will incur a capital gains tax. If you sell the house within 2 years, then any gain you accrue at the time of sale will be short term and will be added to your income and you will have to pay income tax on it according to your tax bracket.



However, if you sell the house after 2 years, then you have to pay long term capital gains tax.

1. Property purchased and sold before **23/07/2024** - Indexation and 20% rate only

Property purchased prior to **23rd July 2024**, can avail the benefit of indexation. Indexation was introduced to consider the impact of inflation on the pricing of property.

Cost of acquisition when multiplied by indexation factor will give indexed cost of acquisition. When you minus indexed cost of acquisition and transfer expenses from the selling amount of the property, the amount you get will incur a flat **20% capital gains tax**.

2. Property purchased before **23/07/2024** but **sold** after **23/07/2024** - **indexation with 20%** or without indexation 12.5% - option of the assessee (this option is only for Individuals and HUF).

3. **Property purchased and sold after 23/07/2024** - **without indexation 12.5%** only. However, please note that any property purchased after 23rd July, 2024 cannot avail the benefit of indexation and you will have to pay flat **12.5% capital gains tax** on the appreciated amount.





6.2 Capital Gains Tax at the time of Sale (Continued)



Furthermore, if your income is below basic exemption limit, then your short/long term gain is decreased by the amount by which you fall short of the basic exemption limit.

- Lastly, if you reinvest the amount earned from sale of a house, into specified assets like another house or REC bonds then capital gains is exempt.
- If you need further clarification on your accounting and tax planning, please feel free to contact CA. Devashree Mathur, Partner at M/s Agrawal Mathur & Associates, Bhopal (Mobile: +91-96915 94142). She helped us with this section of the book.





7.1 Home Loan:

To give you a home loan, banks check your nominal minimum income eligibility. Banks provide home loan on the basis of

- The income generated from your business,
- Or salary earned from your job.

7.1.1 Salaried Individuals:

- For banks, 60-65% of your salary can be considered for EMI. For example, if your salary is 1 lakh rupees per month and you have 0 liability then banks can give up to 60-65 Lakhs loan.
- Second important factor banks consider is age, which further decides the duration of the loan. If your pension is assured by your employer or the government then you may get the loan for up to 70 years of age. For example, you are 40 and you can assure the bank that you will get pension, then banks can give loan for 30 years until you are 70. However, if you are working in a Multi-National Company and your job does not have a provision for pension, then the cut off age is generally 60. So, for example you are 40, and your job doesn't have a provision for pension then you will get the loan for further 20 years as the cut off age is 60.

7.1.1.1 Documents required for a salaried person:

- Last 3 months salary slips
- Last 2-3 years Income Tax Returns and form 16
- Last 6 months bank statement of the salary account

Documents for salaried person



3 months salary slips



3 years of ITR



6 months bank statement

60-65 % of your salary can be considered for EMI



7.1.2 Business Owners

- For business owners loan eligibility is calculated on the basis of the average income of last 3 years. Any existing loan liability is deducted and interest is added back to the aggregate income to determine loan eligibility. Usually, loan can be given for up to the age of 70 years. For example, if the person is 40 years old and has a strong balance sheet showing decent income over the last 3 years, then loan can be given for 30 years until the person is of 70 years of age.

7.1.2.1 Documents required for a business owner

- Last 3 years ITR
- Last 3 years 26 S
- Gumasta
- GST certificate
- 6 months bank statement
- If the person fulfills the income eligibility criteria, then he or she can avail home loan of up to 75-80% of the property value. If the property value is upwards of 1 cr then he can get up to 75% in loan and if the property value is less than 1 cr then he can get up to 80% in loan. Another way to increase your loan amount to approximately 90% is including the cost of interiors in the estimate.



3 years of ITR



Last 3 years
26s



GST Certificate



6 months bank
statement

Documents
Required for
business owners



7.2 Under what circumstances can banks deny you a home loan?

- If the CIBIL score is less than 700
- If you have any unpaid dues on existing loans
- If you haven't paid any of your installments regularly
- If you have defaulted on any of your credit card payments
- If you have defaulted on payment of your personal loan or car/2-wheeler loan

7.2.1 How to improve your CIBIL score?

Get a credit card or a consumer loan and make regular and on time payments of your dues for the next 4 months. This will improve your CIBIL score.

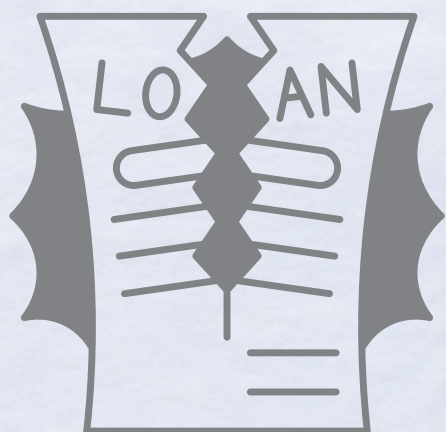
Why Banks Can Deny You Loan ?



Irregular Installments



Unpaid Dues



Defaults on Loan
(Personal/Car Loan)

CIBIL
Less than 700



7.2.2 How should a customer decide which bank to go to?

The rate of interest for all the banks is more or less the same. All the banks are under RBI governance and its Repo rate.

If you want to go to a private then HDFC is good and for nationalized banks, Bank of Baroda and SBI are ok. However, we are of the opinion that you should use NBFCs (Non-Banking Finance Companies) primarily because they are specialized in providing home loans, whereas for other banks home loan is just another vertical. For example, LIC HFL is an NBFC and they have mastery over distributing home loans, they usually provide good service. Banks on the other hand are burdened with other work so may or may not be able to provide equally good service as compared to NBFCs.

The best thing about LIC HFL is there is no hidden charges for search and valuation, processing fees is nominal, no pre penalty charges, no hidden costs and service is good.

7.2.3 You should ask your bank or NBFC about –

- Pre penalty charges in case you pay back the loan before time
- Any lock in period
- Any charges if you want your loan to be taken over by another bank
- Processing fees
- Any search and valuation fees

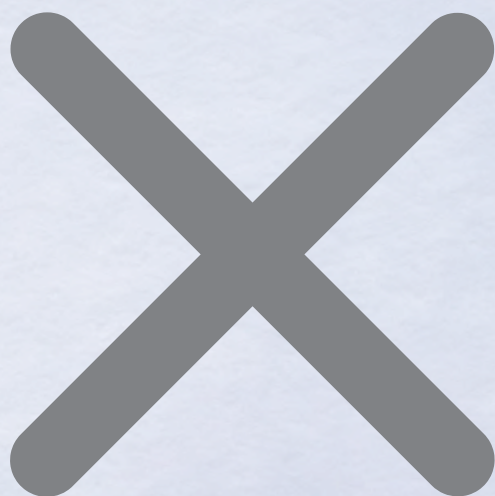


Rate of % shouldn't be more than 0.25% than any nationalized bank

How to increase your income eligibility?

You can increase your income eligibility by adding any potential income from parental property, income earned by wife/son/daughter.

Loans from Private
& Nationalised
Banks



Loans from NBFC





7.3 Commercial Loans

Mortgage loan for a commercial property can be given for up to 70-75% of the property. The rate of interest for commercial loan is 1.25% higher than home loans. Stamp duty for home loans is 0.25% but for commercial loans its 0.5% and processing fees is also usually double than home loans. The maximum term for a commercial loan is 15 years. However, if the profile is good, then through special permissions you can get commercial loans for up to 20 years.

7.3.1 Which banks can entertain weak CIBIL profile?

Private banks like Hinduja Home Finance, Shriram Housing Finance, Aadhar Housing Finance, SMFG Grihashakti Home Finance, Capri etc can entertain people with weak CIBIL profile but then they charge 1.25% higher than other banks.

For further clarifications on loans and mortgages, please contact Mr Arshad (+91 9827224121). He helped us with this section of the book.



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